- Regulates blood sugar levels.
- Lowers cholesterol levels.
- It is essential for normal functioning of skin and nerve system.

Food Sources of Niacin

Liver, chicken, meat, prawns, fish, legumes, cereal, mushroom, peanuts, green leafy vegetables, broccoli, dates, peas, groundnuts, almonds, sunflower seeds, avocado are rich in Niacin.

Symptoms of Niacin deficiency

- A mild deficiency of niacin may result in a coated tongue, sores in the mouth, irritability, nervousness, skin lesions, diarrhoea, forgetfulness, insomnia and headache.
- **Pellegra** - Niacin deficiency leads to Pellagra-a disease of 3D's- dermatitis, diarrhoea and dementia followed by death (if not treated).
- Dermatitis - This includes rough, scaly pigmented skin with rash on skin exposed to sunlight.
- Diarrhoea - loose stools and vomiting.
- Dementia - Symptoms include nerve damage, numbness in limbs, tingling in hands and feet, poor muscle coordination, disorientation and loss of memory.

11.3.4 Vitamin B_6 (Pyridoxine)

Pyridoxine is a colourless compound soluble in water and alcohol. It is well absorbed in the upper segment of the small intestine. It is stored in muscle but found in tissues throughout the body.



Fig 11.3: Symptoms of B_3 deficiency

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